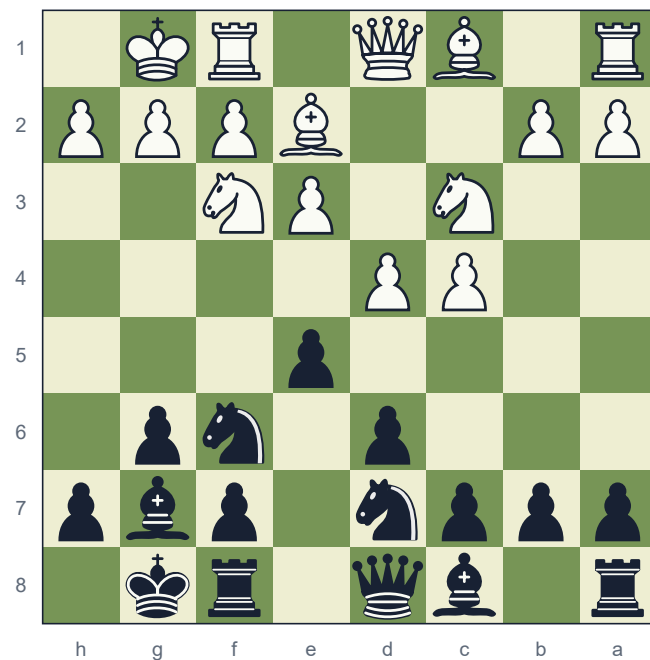


White omits e4 - e3 and quiet c4 systems

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. Nf3 O-O 5. e3 d6 6. Be2 Nbd7 7. O-O e5

YOUR BLACK REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Develop with ...d6 and ...Nbd7, then challenge with ...e5. White's smaller center allows different piece play and may transpose to e4 systems later.



Main study anchor - White to move

READ THE CENTER

White has d4/e3 instead of d4/e4. The g7 bishop may see more of the center, and Black can gain central space.

WHAT WHITE WANTS

White develops safely with Bd3, Be2, b3 or b4 and may prepare e4 later. Quiet moves can still support a strong queenside plan.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Check whether e4 has actually been played.
2. Use central space without overextending.
3. Reclassify the position after e4.

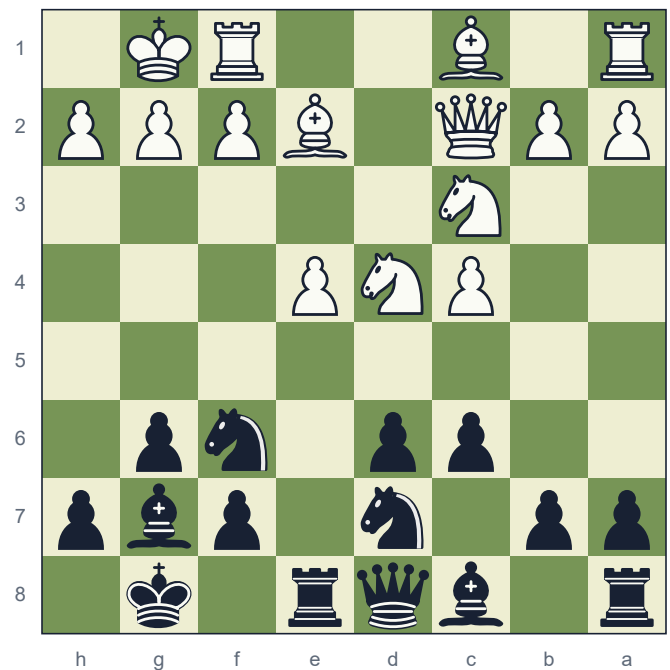
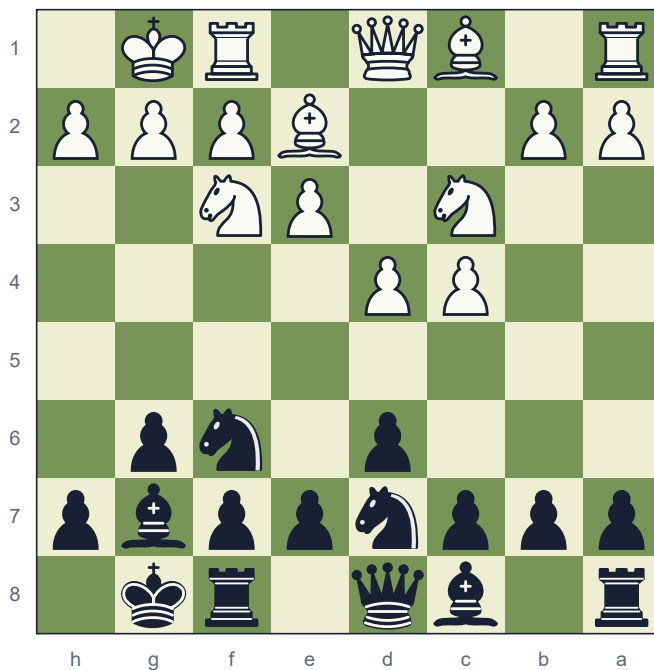
Original repertoire choices and commentary. Public opening names and move-order references, plus local Stockfish checks. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 Be2 and central development

STUDY LINE 17-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. Nf3 O-O 5. e3 d6 6. Be2 Nbd7 7. O-O e5 8. e4 exd4 9. Nxd4 c6 10. Qc2 Re8

Selected anchor ends with 7... e5. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

Black completes development and establishes a central pawn contact. White has not yet claimed e4.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Compare ...Re8 and ...c6, and watch dxe5 or d5. Choose a plan from the new center after White resolves the tension.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Do not assume d5 creates the same strong White chain; e3 rather than e4 changes central control.

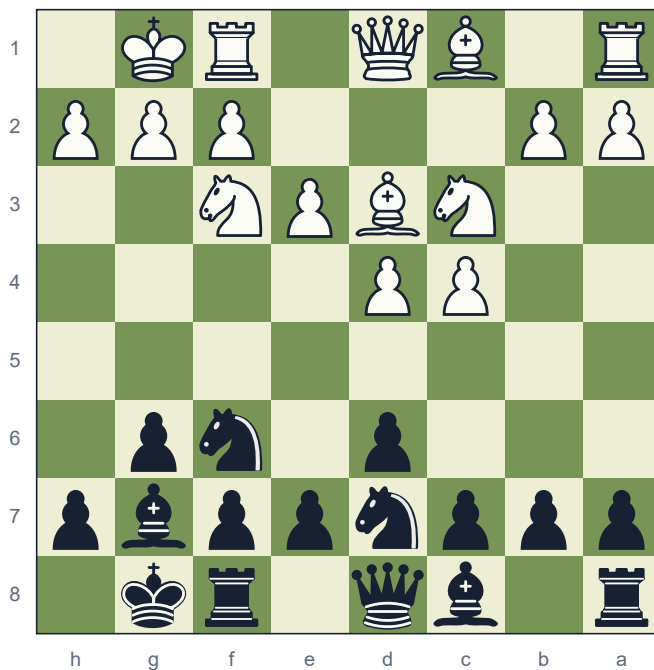
REMEMBER A smaller center gives Black more room to choose.

02 Bd3 before castling

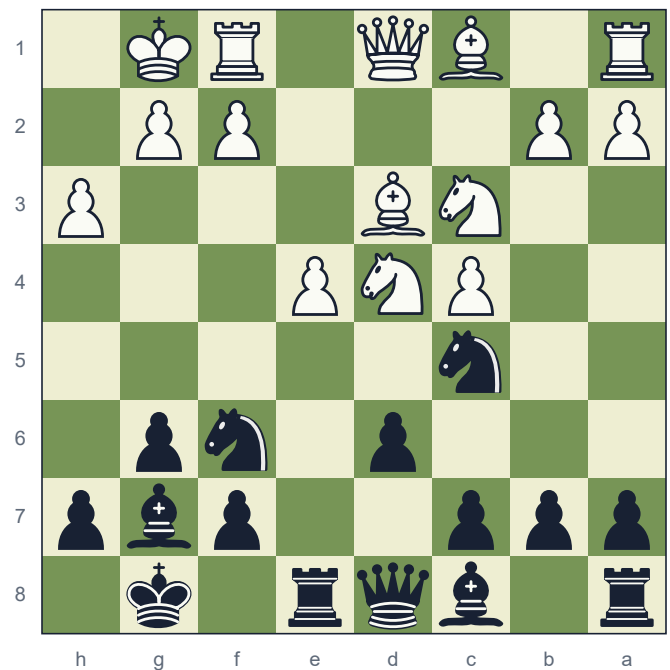
STUDY LINE 17-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. Nf3 O-O 5. e3 d6 6. Bd3 Nbd7 7. O-O e5 8. h3 Re8 9. e4 exd4 10. Nxd4 Nc5

Selected anchor ends with 7... e5. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 7... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

Bd3 supports a later e4 but can also face a tempo-gaining ...e4 if White neglects the center.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Improve the rooks and calculate the central advance before playing it. Maintain pressure on d4.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

A pawn fork on e4 works only if the pawn can survive its defenders and captures.

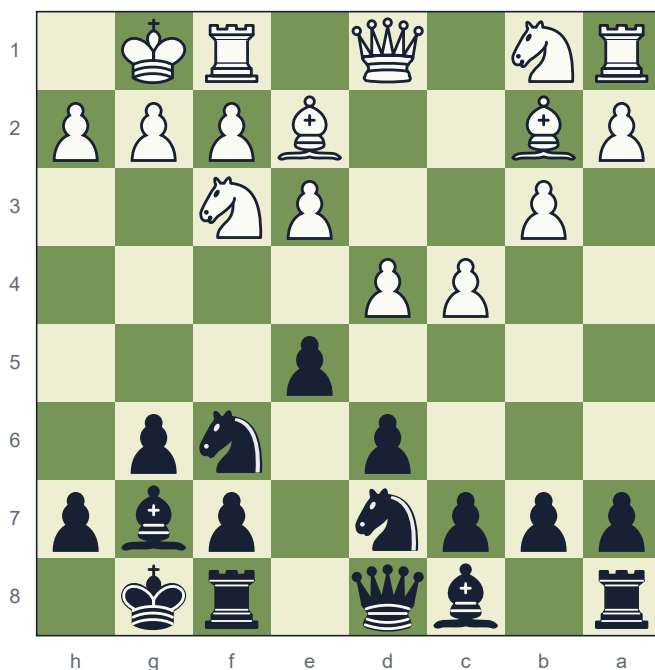
REMEMBER A familiar bishop square can be a tactical target.

03 Double fianchetto without e4

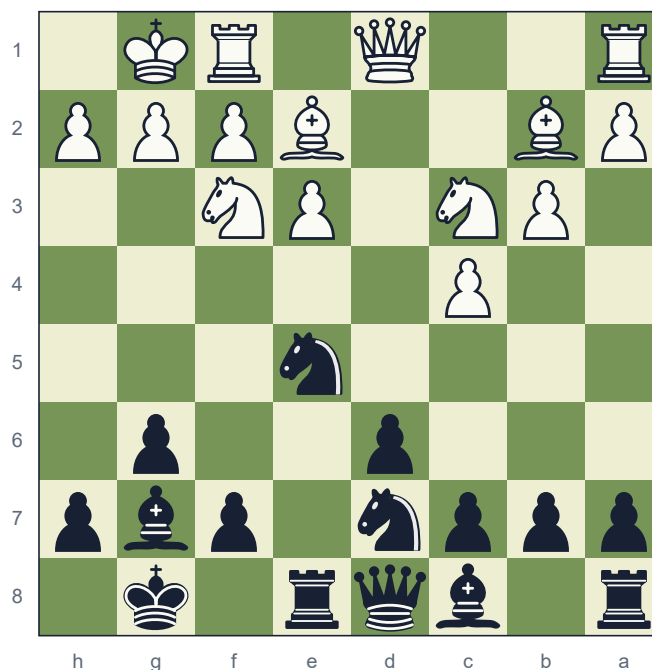
STUDY LINE 17-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nf3 Bg7 4. e3 O-O 5. Be2 d6 6. O-O Nbd7 7. b3 e5 8. Bb2 Re8 9. dxe5 Ng4 10. Nc3 Ngxe5

Selected anchor ends with 8... Re8. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 8... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

White develops both bishops behind a compact center. Black gains space and reinforces e5 with the rook.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Prepare a useful central break or piece maneuver. Keep the long diagonal from b2 to g7 in view.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

An opening of the e-file or long diagonal can change king safety quickly.

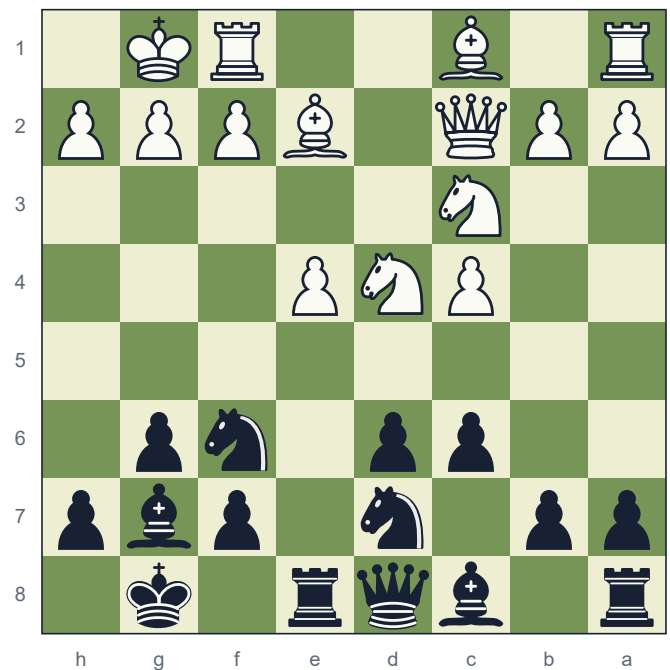
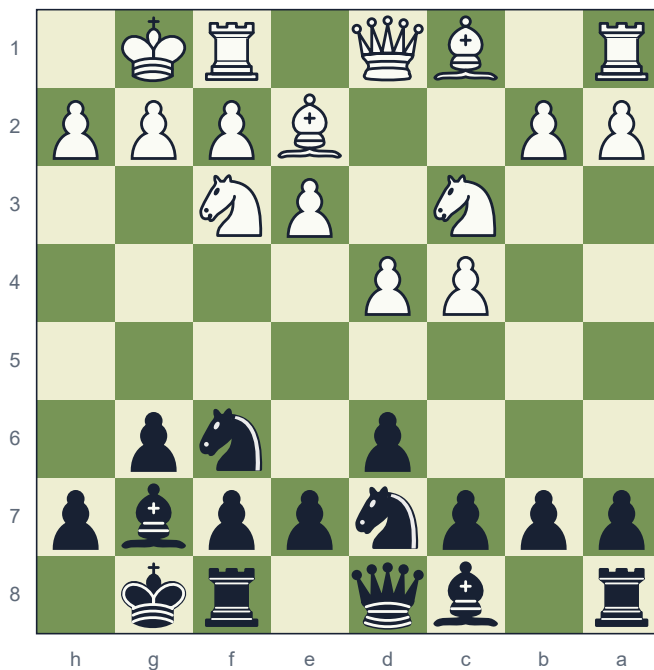
REMEMBER Central space and long diagonals must be evaluated together.

04 White adds e4 later

STUDY LINE 17-04

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. Nf3 O-O 5. e3 d6 6. Be2 Nbd7 7. O-O e5 8. e4 exd4 9. Nxd4 c6 10. Qc2 Re8

Selected anchor ends with 8. e4. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

White spends two moves reaching e4, but the resulting center is familiar. Black's b8 knight is on d7, not c6.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

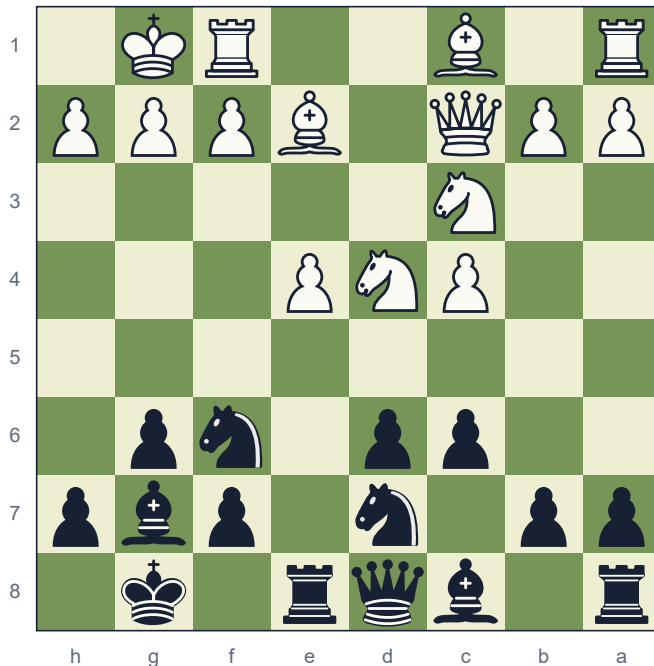
Use ...Re8 or ...c6 as appropriate and decide how to meet d5. Do not invent a c6-knight retreat in a position without that knight.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

A transposition must include the tempo count and knight placement.

REMEMBER Check every piece before declaring a transposition.

Review before your next game



Main-line endpoint - White to move

1. CLASSIFY THE CENTER

White has d4/e3 instead of d4/e4. The g7 bishop may see more of the center, and Black can gain central space.

2. NAME WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White develops safely with Bd3, Be2, b3 or b4 and may prepare e4 later. Quiet moves can still support a strong queenside plan.

3. CHOOSE A USEFUL JOB

Compare ...Re8 and ...c6, and watch dxe5 or d5. Choose a plan from the new center after White resolves the tension.

RECONSTRUCT

Set up the starting position and play this booklet's main line. Before every Black move, state White's threat and why your move is safe. Stop at the first point you cannot explain.

BRANCH TEST

Choose one alternative White move from this booklet. Explain what changed: a defender, a pawn contact, a king choice or a tempo. Then reconstruct the response without looking.

PRACTICE

Play the endpoint against a partner or a chess program, switching colors after one game. Record the first new position and your candidate moves. Use the line ID to find it in Repertoire_Lines.pgn.